



There's a lot more you can do with React. Follow this link for just a small example:
<http://dgit.in/ReactArt>

React.js Basics

>>A JavaScript library backed by the largest social networking platform in the world certainly deserves your attention > by Kshitij Sobti

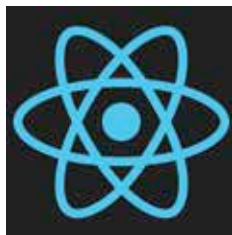
JavaScript libraries and frameworks come and go, but with Facebook behind one, you have to take notice; and the world did. React is in active development and already in use by major websites like Imgur, Netflix and Scribd. React is unique, perhaps even groundbreaking, and definitely controversial in a number of ways as you'll discover as you read along.

What is React?

First and most important, know that React is a library that aims to do one thing, but do it well, the UI. To solve other parts of the web development equation, you'll need to look elsewhere.

Also important to know is that React is very fast thanks to its use of a Virtual DOM technology – we'll look at that in a bit. React also heavily encourages you to use an enhanced version of JavaScript that it calls JSX.

Finally React is oriented around components. All you do with React is create a hierarchy of components that work with each other. For instance you could create a toolbar composed of ButtonBars, composed of Buttons etc.



Is it the next big thing in web development?

JSX: XML-Rich JavaScript

JSX is JavaScript with an enhanced syntax for declaring components using XML tags directly in code – you'll see this in action soon. Since this isn't standard JavaScript, you need to compile to the equivalent JavaScript before it can be loaded by the browser.

This compilation can be performed in the browser itself by including the Babel compiler along with your JSX scripts on your page. The preferred way, especially for production is to compile them in advance.

It's also entirely possible to use React with a pure JavaScript syntax if you want, however JSX is definitely the cleaner, simpler and clearer route. If you do use JSX, you can also begin using the latest JavaScript features and syntax since the Babel compiler will also convert those features to work with current browsers.

The Virtual DOM

The DOM, or the Document Object Model is a convention for rich object-oriented iterations with a document. In case of browsers the DOM is what let's you manipulate the HTML content of a page. The is essentially how JavaScript is able to provide any kind of interactivity.

The problem with it though is that performing a large number of operations on a page can be really slow, especially if done inefficiently. The virtual DOM is the magic behind React's great performance. React

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